TORTELLI

REGION	REST
Across Italy, particularly Emilia-Romagna and Lombardy	**45 minutes to 1 hour uncovered in the refrigerator**

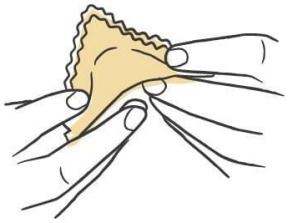
METHOD

1. Make your chosen egg-based dough, then roll and sheet it.
2. Line a sheet pan with parchment and dust it with semolina.
3. Lay one sheet out. Cut it into 2 1/2-inch squares with a fluted dough divider. A fluted pastry cutter with a ruler, or a knife with a ruler, works too. Keep the squares under plastic wrap or a towel.
4. Load the filling into a pastry bag cut to a 1/2-inch opening. Pipe a quarter-sized dab of filling into the middle of each square.
5. If the dough feels dry rather than moderately tacky, mist the squares with a spray bottle held 8 to 10 inches above the work surface. Skip this if the dough is already tacky.
6. Hold a square in your palm and fold one corner across toward its opposite, stopping a little short of the far edge so the two ruffled edges sit tiered rather than flush.
7. Pinch the edges shut around the filling with thumb and index finger. Work back and forth a few times and push all the air out.
8. Press a dimple into the center of the filled side with your index finger.
9. Hold both ends of the triangle with the dimple facing you, bring the ends together, and cross them over each other very slightly so the piece takes a canoe shape with the filling in the middle. Pinch the ends closed firmly.
10. Set the piece on the prepared pan. Fill and fold the rest of the squares, keeping them in a single layer, and dust the pan again with semolina.
11. Repeat with the remaining sheets.
12. Refrigerate uncovered for 45 minutes to 1 hour to dry. Covered pieces sweat and get too wet. To hold longer, lay plastic wrap loosely over the pan and refrigerate up to 8 hours.

SHAPING



1



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3



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NOTES

Sheet is cut into 2 1/2-inch squares with a fluted dough divider, so the edges are ruffled.
Filling per piece: a quarter-sized circle piped through a 1/2-inch opening.
The fold deliberately stops short of the far corner, landing a little below it, so the two fluted edges tier instead of lining up. That offset is part of the look.
Seal geometry: fold corner to corner into a triangle, pinch the edges, dimple the filled side, then bring the two ends together and cross them slightly into a canoe or boat. Crossing the ends in front, rather than closing them into a ring underneath, is the difference from tortellini.
Air must be forced out of the edges as you pinch.
This step list omits the 00 flour dusting of the work surface that the other shapes call for. Only the sheet pan gets prepared.
Storage: 45 minutes to 1 hour uncovered to dry, then up to 8 hours refrigerated under loose plastic.
Filled with squash flavored with mostarda, or with cheese and greens and sauced with restraint. Close cousin of cappellacci di zucca from Ferrara.

DOUGH

Egg Dough

Makes: 954 g / Active Time: 8-10 min kneading / Rest: 30 min minimum, wrapped

INGREDIENTS

500 g	Tipo 00 flour
454 g	Egg yolks
as needed	Extra 00 flour for kneading
up to 1 tbsp, only if dry	Room-temperature water

METHOD

1. Mix the yolks lightly, without beating them.
2. Mound the flour on a wooden surface and open a well 5 to 6 inches across. Wider than that and the walls collapse.
3. Add half the yolks, drawing in flour from the inner wall with a fork, working round the circumference.
4. Add the rest the same way. If the wall breaks, scrape the escape back into the flour until the mass holds itself.
5. Knead 8 to 10 minutes: press down and away with the heel of your hand, rotate 180 degrees, fold, repeat. Scrape your hands and the board as you go.
6. Add water a tablespoon at a time only if it stays dry and refuses to come together.
7. Stop when it is smooth, firm, and springs back slightly when poked. The texture to aim for is Play-Doh.
8. Wrap and rest at least 30 minutes before rolling.

NOTES

454 g of yolks is roughly 24 to 26 eggs, so plan what the whites are for.
Yolks only, no whites and no whole eggs, which is what makes this rich and tender rather than elastic.
Dry winter air is the usual reason it will not come together. Flour the board sparingly, since excess dries it out.
Keeps 24 hours. Chilled overnight, pull it out 20 minutes before rolling.

DATE ____ / ____ / ____ RATING ____ / 5 OVEN ADJ _____

NOTES _____

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